EVENT INFORMATION & REGISTRATION FLOW

Academic Event Info.



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Systems Design
Sem V, Sec C, Sep 26'

Research Area

Our research area looks at how academic campus events, like conferences, symposiums, design fests, and workshops, are organized and run behind the scenes. Most people think an event is just about putting up a poster and having attendees fill out a Google Form. In reality, a campus event is a chain reaction involving college authorities, teachers, student teams, invited guests, and attendees. We are studying what happens from the day an event is first planned to the day people actually walk into the hall.



Process

How We Progressed



System Understaning

Defined the project boundary around campus academic events, audited existing communication touchpoints, and studied how event operations currently function across departments.

Interviews & Data

Carried out targeted, semi-structured interviews with faculty leads, student organizers, and attendees to uncover both internal operational hurdles and participant friction points.

Findings & Insights

Clustered and synthesized raw field findings to uncover underlying systemic breakdowns, such as over-reliance on key people, delayed administrative approvals, and fragmented communication channels.

Systems Mapping

Translated the categorized insights into visual systems frameworks, using stakeholder ecosystems, information flows, and root-cause diagrams to illustrate where the system breaks down.

What We're Looking At :

Understanding Events

Stakeholders

Mapping the different people involved, core organizers, departmental sub-teams (branding, logistics, social media), faculty, and student attendees, and examining how reliance on specific individuals creates bottlenecks when answers are needed.

Information Flow

Examining how event details distort, delay, or get lost as they move down the hierarchy (core team > coordinators > class representatives > students), leaving teams out of sync and students with incomplete context before signing up.

Communication Flow

Analyzing how announcements and updates get fragmented across posters, emails, and crowded WhatsApp groups, where critical details get buried in chat clutter without a single, reliable source of truth.

Registration Flow

Tracking the journey from initial sign-up to post-event wrap-up, including missing confirmation passes, lack of schedule reminders, and inconsistent, confusing processes for distributing certificates.



Research Overview



- Stakeholder Flow
- Communication Flow
- Information Flow

We analyzed the flow of information, communication and registrations of academic events like symposiums, conferences, and workshops. By auditing existing communication touchpoints, registration forms, and circulars, we mapped out standard institutional procedures to identify typical points of failure across campus departments.

Then, we conducted field research with students, faculty, and student council members to evaluate real-world interactions. Inquiries were split into two focus groups: Organizers (backstage logistics, administrative delays, and internal team coordination) and Attendees (event discovery, registration friction, and post-event deliverables).

Interview Findings #1

Fragmented Channels	Information is scattered across WhatsApp groups, Instagram, emails, posters, and word of mouth. Without a single source of truth, vital updates get buried in chat clutter.
Hierarchical Context Loss	As information filters down through multiple layers (Core Team > Leads > Coordinators > CRs > General Students), the original context, clarity, and intent get progressively distorted, shortened, or lost.
Peer-Driven Information Discovery	Students rarely discover events through official university channels alone; they rely on informal bridges like faculty verbal reminders, peer chats, and volunteer outreach.

Interview Findings #2

Information Deficit	Event details are scattered across disparate platforms (WhatsApp, email, posters, word-of-mouth) without a single reliable source of truth. Critical dates, rules, and announcements get buried in high-noise chat groups.
Inconsistent Event Cycle	Promotional collateral often provides only bare-minimum teasers (e.g., just a title or poster) rather than functional context (prerequisites, detailed agenda, speaker backgrounds, expected takeaways), which creates hesitation and reduces registration conversion.
Erratic Post-Event Fulfillment	There is no standardized lifecycle following registration. The touchpoint chain, from ticket confirmations and schedule-conflict reminders to on-ground check-in and certificate distribution, is erratic, poorly tracked, and causes significant post-event confusion.

Interview Findings #3

Administrative Dependency	Public announcements are not the starting point of the system; unresolved upstream factors (such as delayed budget sanctions, resource constraints, and venue clearances) dictate what can be communicated and when.
Planning Cycles	Event planning rarely follows a fixed linear timeline. It behaves as a dynamic, shifting process where coordinators must constantly adapt to unexpected last-minute changes.
Undocumented Knowledge	Critical operational decisions often exist purely as mental notes or verbal agreements rather than recorded, structured data, making execution inconsistent.

Interview Findings #4

Gatekeeper Dependency	Access to essential information depends heavily on knowing the specific person holding it (a particular faculty member, coordinator, or student lead). If that person is unavailable, decision-making and operations stall.
Informal Relational Networks	Operational efficiency relies on personal relationships, informal connections, and past experience rather than documented roles or an organizational chart.
Inter-Team Confusion	Internal teams (branding, logistics, installation, social media, registration) frequently operate on conflicting or outdated information, leading to duplicated effort and overlapping tasks.

Key Insights

Core Aspects

Fragile Informal Networks

Planning depends on personal contacts and word-of-mouth rather than a formal system, creating immediate bottlenecks if one person is unavailable.

Delayed Decisions

Upstream issues like delayed budget or venue approvals stall communication, causing message details and context to warp as they filter down the chain.

Scattered Channels

Event information gets lost across cluttered chat groups without sufficient upfront context, while confirmations and certificates remain unpredictable.

Problem Areas :

Dependancy on Specific People

Planning runs mostly on informal connections, personal relationships, and mental notes rather than documented roles or written guidelines. Because operational knowledge stays locked in the heads of a few individuals, the setup becomes fragile: if a specific faculty lead or student coordinator is unavailable, workflows grind to a halt because nobody else has the context or authority to keep tasks moving.

Important Details Get Scrambled

Event updates travel through an extended human chain, from the core team to coordinators, class representatives, and finally attendees, losing context and accuracy like a game of telephone. At the same time, information is scattered across noisy WhatsApp chats, personal messages, emails, and physical posters, meaning critical deadlines, schedules, and venue updates get buried without a single official source.

Delayed Decisions, Rushed Announcements

Organizers cannot announce events until upstream permissions like room bookings, budget sanctions, and guest clearances are signed off by the administration. Because these approvals move slowly and unpredictably, promotion windows shrink, forcing teams to roll out rushed, bare-minimum teasers without complete schedules or speaker details, which leaves students confused and hesitant to sign up.

Communication Drops Off After Registration

The attendee journey abruptly breaks right after submitting a Google Form, leaving students without entry passes, confirmation emails, or schedule reminders. This absence of post-registration tracking causes disorganized on-ground check-ins on event day and leads to weeks of students chasing organizers over missing certificates and attendance records.

Problem Statement :

The event management system lacks a clear and consistent flow of information across people, teams, and stages, causing information to be lost, delayed, or inconsistently communicated throughout the event lifecycle.

Possible Success Metrics :

Registration Lead Time & Turnout Rate

Increase in pre-event registrations at least 48 hours prior to the event (targeting a 30–40% increase in early sign-ups) and a higher conversion rate from registration to actual on-ground attendance.

Approval & Planning Turnaround Time

Reduction in the total number of days required to move an event from ideation to public announcement (e.g., cutting admin/budget clearance lag from 2 weeks down to under 5 days).

Query Volume & Operational Overhead

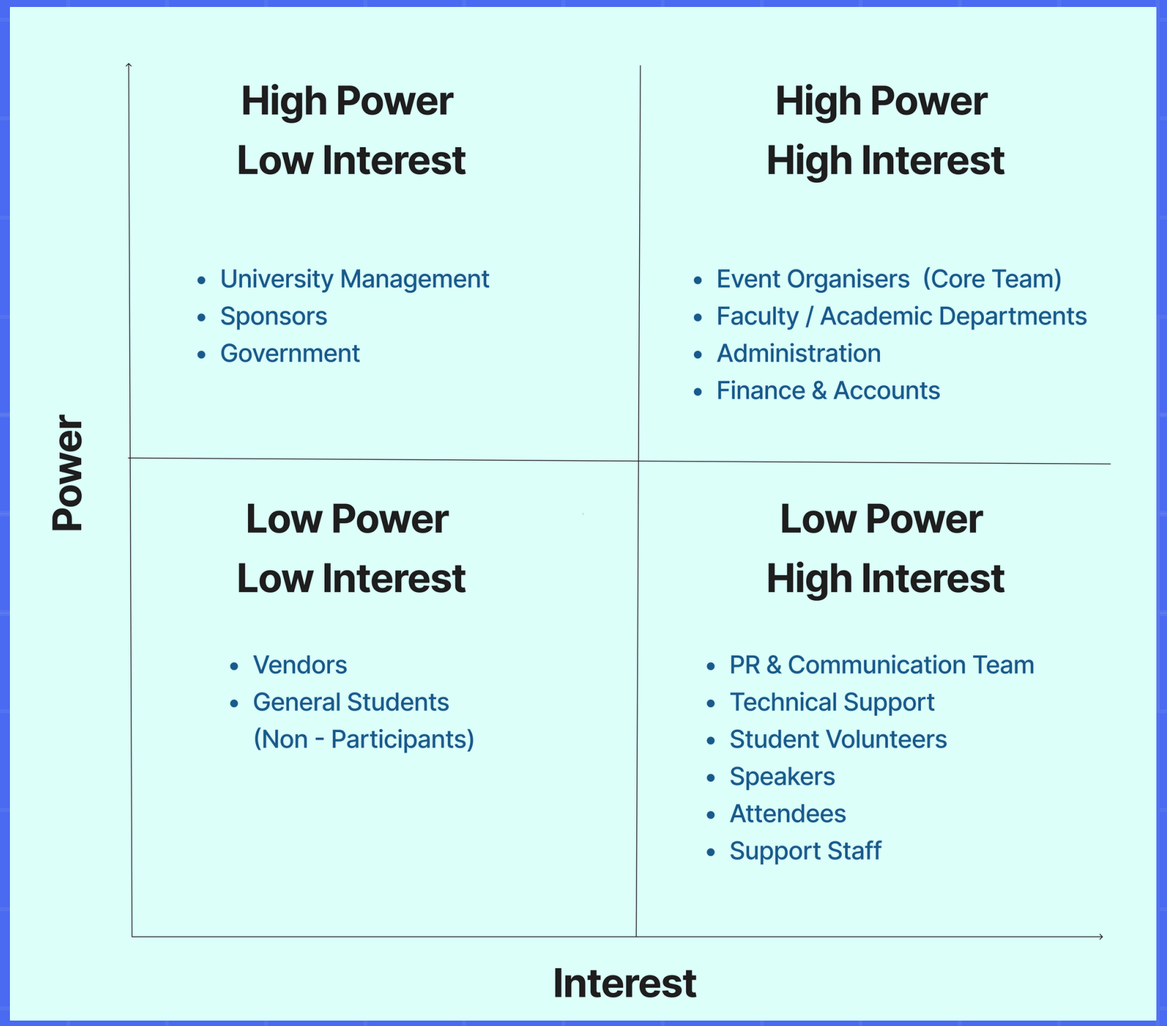
A significant drop (e.g., 50–60% reduction) in repetitive student inquiries and manual follow-ups across informal WhatsApp groups regarding timings, passes, and venue confusion.

Post-Event Fulfillment Rate & Turnaround

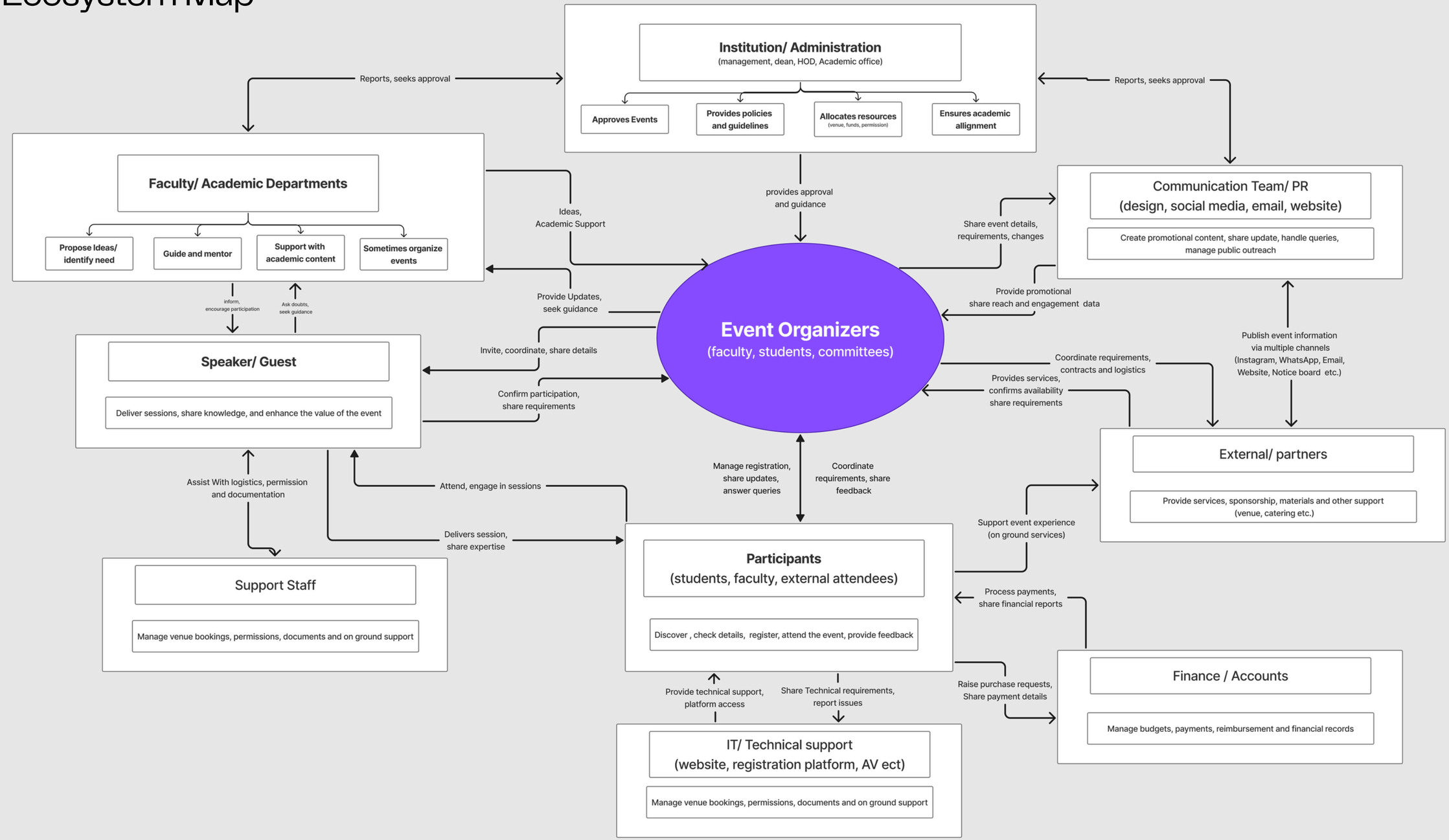
95%+ of attendees successfully receiving verified attendance records and digital certificates within 24–48 hours post-event, down from several weeks of manual chasing.

Stakeholder Map

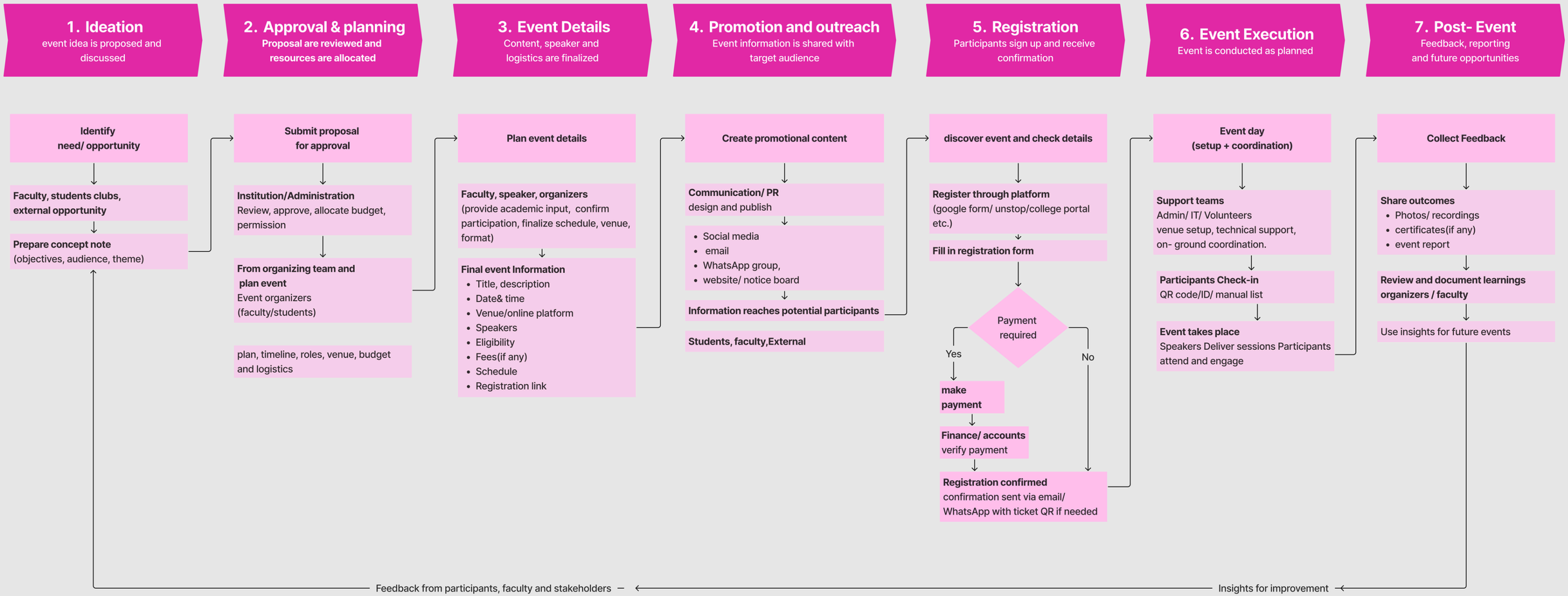




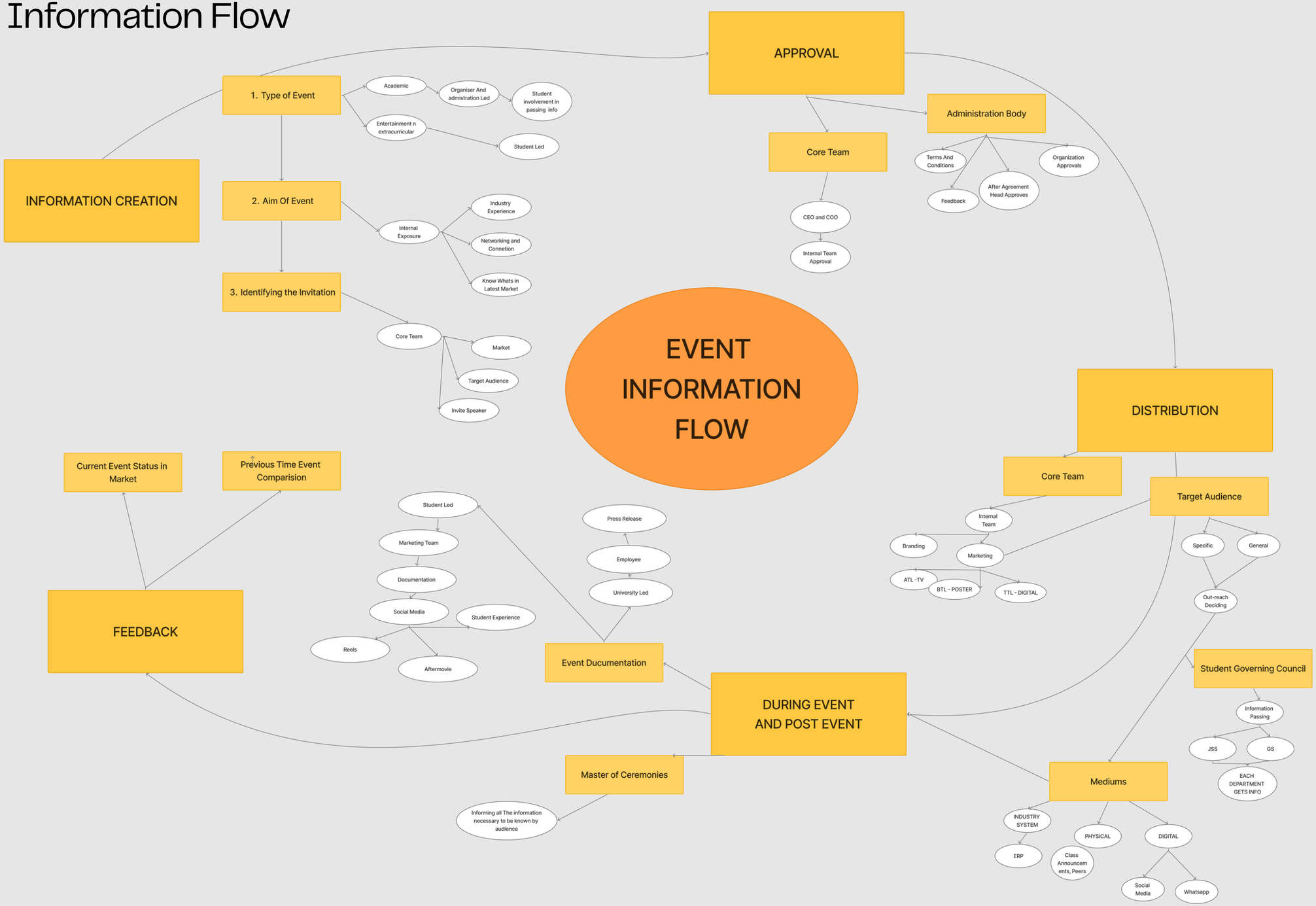
Ecosystem Map



Information and registration system flow map



Information Flow



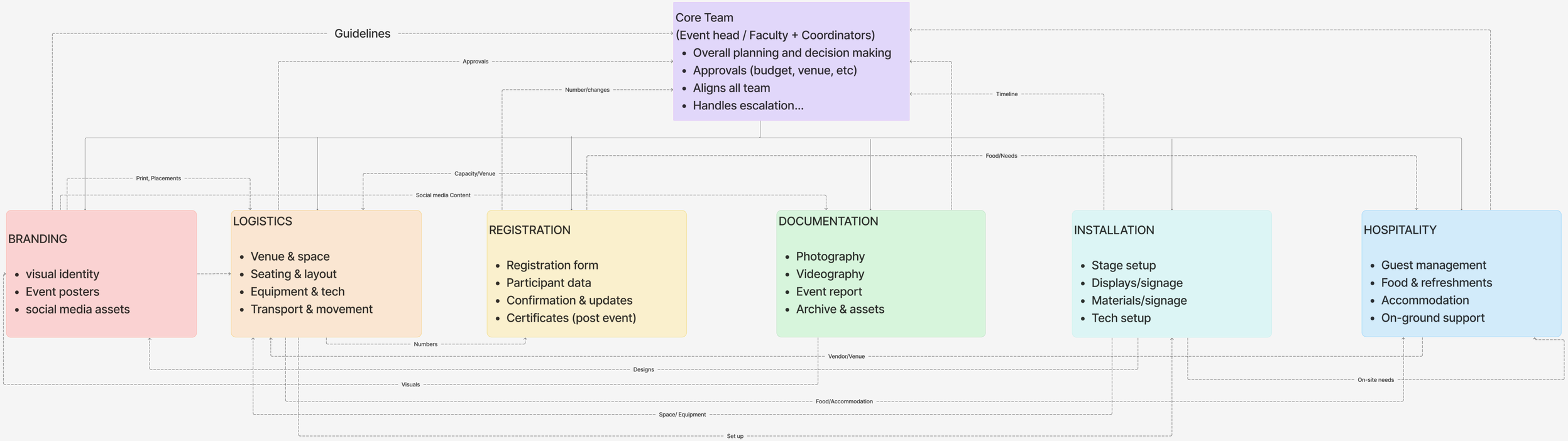
INFORMATION ARCHETECTURE



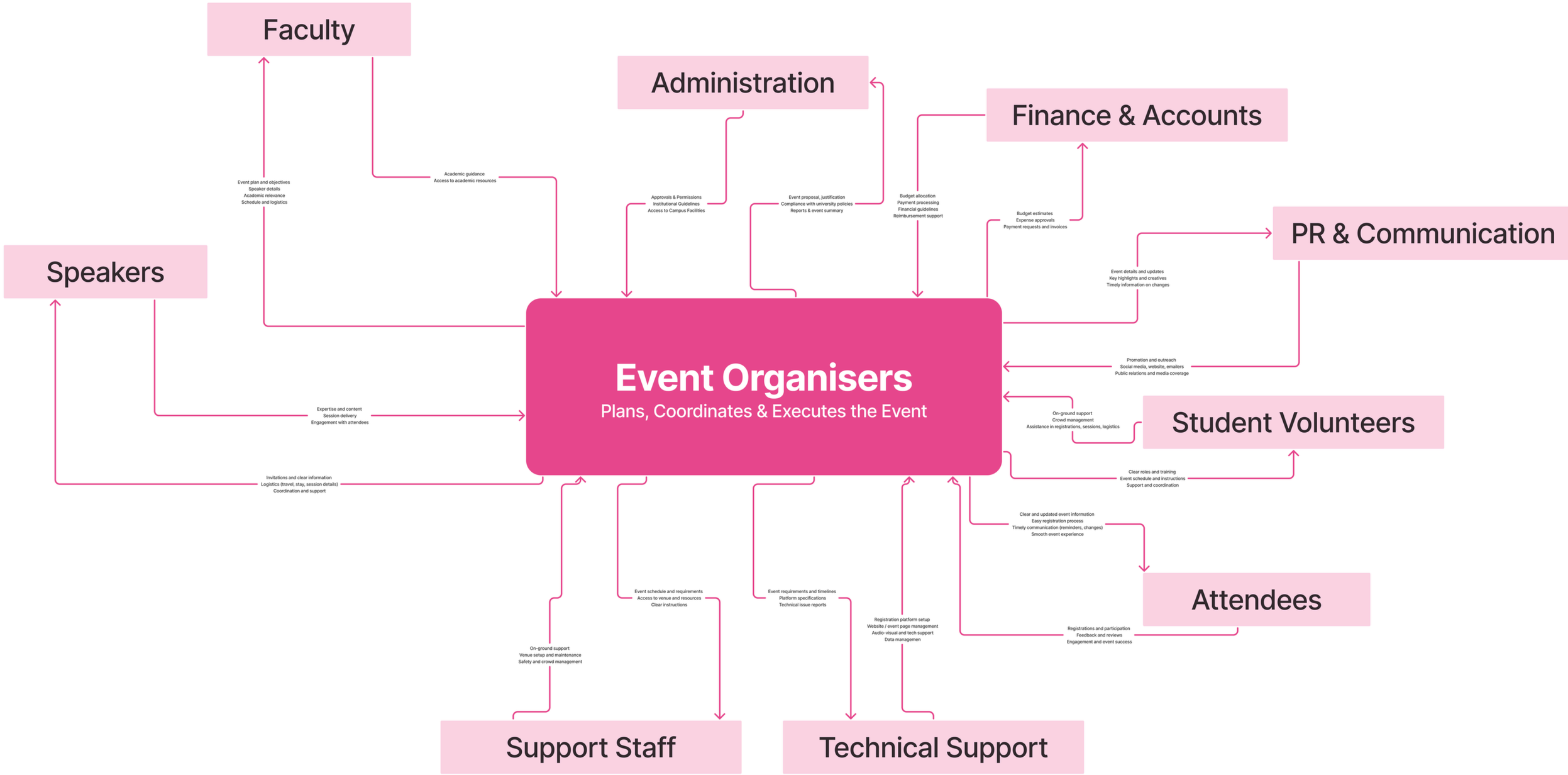
Communication Channel map

S.NO	PHASE	TEAM	MODE
1.	IDEATION	Faculty/ Core team	Verbal Communication (no platform required)
2.	PLANNING	Faculty/ Seniors	Verbal Communication
		Core Team	Meetings/ Brainstorming
3.	TEAM FORMATION	Faculty to Students	Verbal first then WhatsApp
4.	TASK ALLOCATION	Senior/ Team heads	WhatsApp/ Direct Communication
5.	EXECUTION	Heads	• WhatsApp group information • Direct Communication
6.	EVENT DAY		• WhatsApp • Calls • Face to Face/ Verbal

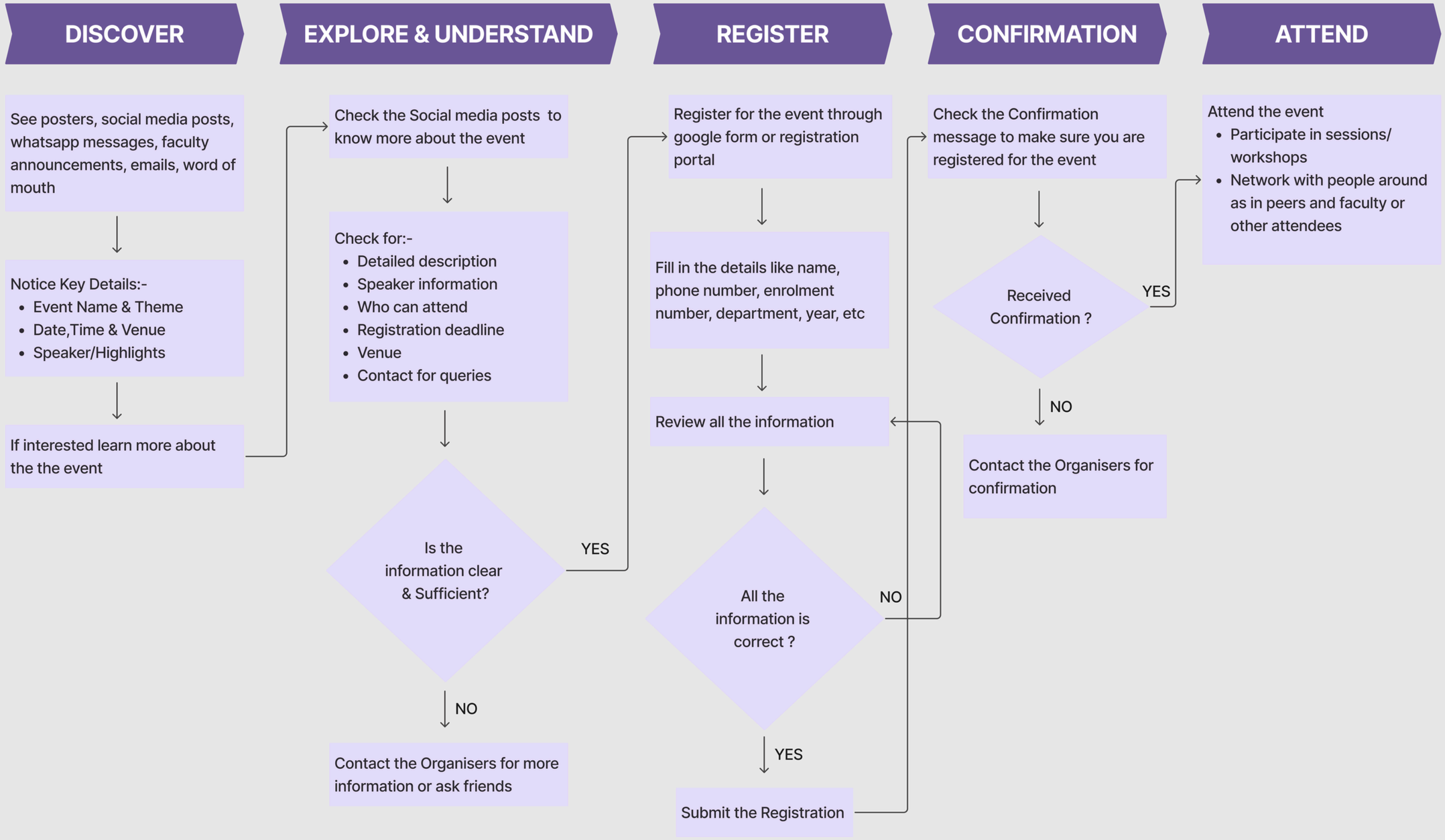
Internal Team Communication map



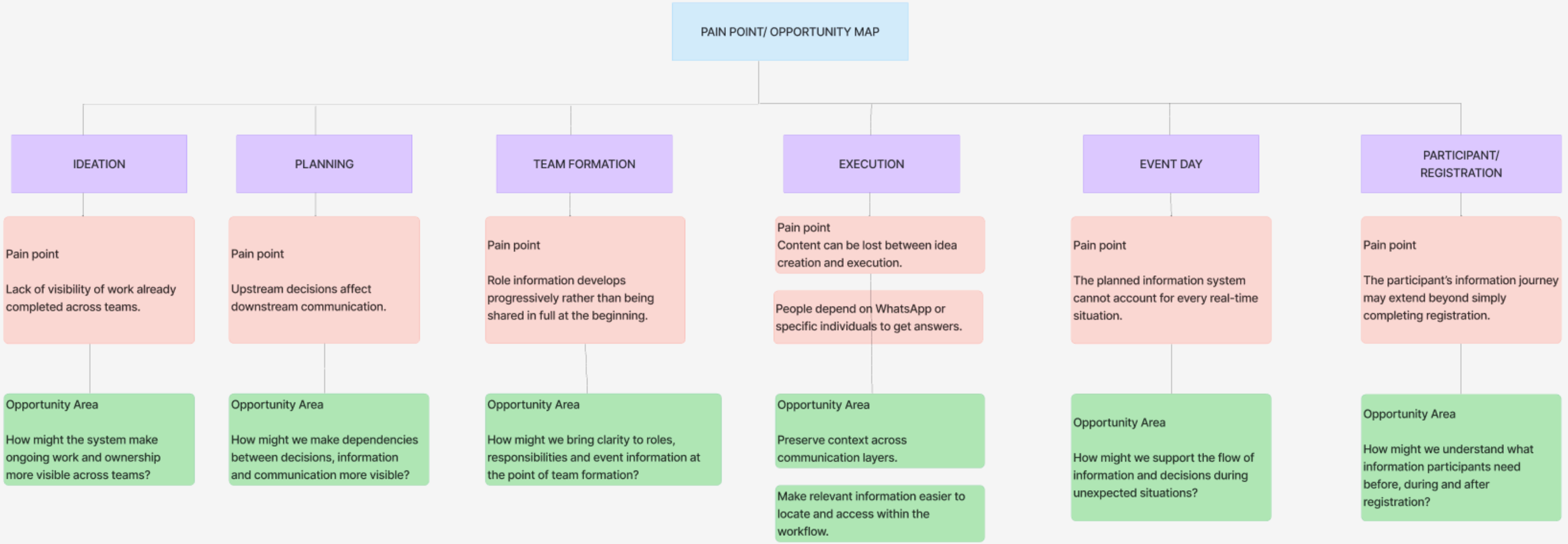
Dependency map



Registration Flow



Pain point / Opportunity Map



Thank You

So Much

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